By now, most state governments had announced strict restrictions on movement, closed down restaurants, cinemas, schools and colleges and banned public gatherings. Within the next couple of days, even before the prime minister would announce a national lockdown, Bihar, Chandigarh, Chhattisgarh, Delhi, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Manipur, Odisha, Punjab, Puducherry, Rajasthan (first state to issue complete lockdown), Sikkim, Tamil Nadu, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand and West Bengal would issue various curbs and curfews. A noteworthy piece of information is that none of these aforementioned states gave any prior warning before issuing total curfew or lockdown orders. Several large groups had begun to reach out to the prime minister calling for an immediate, total restriction in movement. A group of venture capitalists and leading start-ups appealed to the prime minister, 'While containment efforts should continue, imposing a lockdown and Section 144 now, versus 30 days later, might reduce deaths by 5x (saving nearly 10,000 lives).'[17]

Leaders from opposition parties had also begun to actively advocate locking down instantly. A case in point, former Union home minister during the UPA regime, P. Chidambaram, posted a series of tweets on 19 March tagging the prime minister, PMOIndia, chief minister of Maharashtra Uddhav Thackeray and (now former) chief minister of Tamil Nadu Edappadi Palaniswami:

> After WHO Director General's statement yesterday, there should be no hesitation in ordering an immediate lockdown of all our towns and cities for 2–4 weeks. Even after we have witnessed what is happening in Italy, Iran and Spain, why is the government refusing to take the logical step of a lockdown? Some states that are ahead of the central government should go ahead and lock down their towns and cities. Since ICMR's random sample testing has revealed that there is no community transmission (Stage 3) so far, this is the moment to announce a temporary lockdown and contain the disease at Stage 2.[18]

While some of them, like the aforementioned examples, offered data and scientific facts in their advice, others gave headline-making statements to the press without offering any useful suggestions. For instance, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi spoke to media outside Parliament, 'India should be